

OCEAN GUARDIAN INTERNATIONAL LTD

GUARDIAN CERTIFICATION CORE COMPETENCY FRAMEWORK

Levels 1–7

LEVEL 1 — GUARDIAN RESPONDER

40 Hours

Core Competencies

A Level 1 Guardian Responder is trained to recognize emergencies, provide immediate assistance, activate the emergency response system, and support professional responders.

- Emergency Recognition & Scene Assessment
- Personal Safety & Responder Safety
- Emergency Action Plan Awareness
- Emergency Communication & Incident Reporting
- CPR — Adult, Child & Infant
- AED Operation & Application
- Basic First Aid
- Oxygen Administration
- Choking Recognition & Response

- Basic Bleeding Control
- Shock Recognition & Management
- Recovery Position
- Basic Patient Assessment
- Emergency Evacuation Procedures
- Basic Water Emergency Awareness
- Non-Contact Rescue Principles
- Safe Assistance to a Person in Distress
- Incident Documentation
- Post-Incident Procedures
- Emergency Team Coordination

Level 1 Competency Outcome

The Guardian Responder can identify an emergency, protect themselves and others, activate emergency services, provide appropriate immediate care, and assist higher-level Guardians during an emergency.

LEVEL 2 — POOL GUARDIAN

60 Hours

Core Competencies

A Pool Guardian is qualified to supervise and manage aquatic safety operations within designated pool environments.

- All Level 1 Guardian Responder Competencies
- Pool Surveillance & Scanning
- Active Supervision
- Drowning Prevention
- Aquatic Risk Recognition
- Pool Rules & Patron Management
- Emergency Action Plan Implementation
- Water Rescue Techniques
- Reach, Throw & Assist Rescue Methods
- Swimming-Based Rescue Techniques
- Contact & Non-Contact Rescue
- Victim Approach Techniques
- Victim Support & Extraction
- Poolside Rescue Procedures
- Shallow-Water Rescue
- Deep-Water Rescue
- Multiple-Victim Emergency Awareness
- Spinal Injury Recognition & Response
- Aquatic First Response
- CPR/AED Response in Aquatic Environments
- Oxygen Administration
- Pool Facility Safety Inspection
- Hazard Identification
- Incident Reporting & Documentation
- Emergency Team Communication

- Post-Rescue Procedures

Level 2 Competency Outcome

The Pool Guardian can independently perform designated pool surveillance, identify aquatic hazards, prevent incidents, execute appropriate pool rescues, provide emergency care, and implement the facility's emergency procedures.

LEVEL 3 — OPEN WATER GUARDIAN

80 Hours

Core Competencies

An Open Water Guardian is qualified to operate in beaches and designated open-water environments where environmental conditions create additional rescue and risk-management challenges.

- All Level 1 & Level 2 Competencies
- Open Water Surveillance
- Beach & Waterfront Risk Assessment
- Environmental Hazard Recognition
- Current & Wave Awareness
- Weather & Environmental Monitoring
- Rip Current Recognition
- Surf Zone Safety

- Open Water Rescue Techniques
- Long-Distance Rescue Techniques
- Contact & Non-Contact Rescue
- Rescue Tube & Rescue Equipment Operations
- Victim Approach in Open Water
- Victim Stabilization & Control
- Aquatic Extraction Techniques
- Shore-Based Rescue Operations
- Water Entry & Exit Techniques
- Multiple-Victim Emergency Response
- Open Water Emergency Action Plans
- Emergency Communications
- Beach Evacuation Procedures
- Missing Person Response
- Marine Life Hazard Awareness
- Watercraft & Recreational Activity Risk Awareness
- Open Water First Response
- CPR/AED in Open Water Incidents
- Oxygen Administration
- Incident Documentation
- Post-Incident Analysis

Level 3 Competency Outcome

The Open Water Guardian can supervise designated open-water environments, identify environmental and human hazards, conduct open-water rescues, manage aquatic

emergencies, and coordinate emergency response until advanced medical or rescue resources arrive.

LEVEL 4 — GUARDIAN RESCUE TECHNICIAN

120 Hours

Core Competencies

A Guardian Rescue Technician is trained for advanced aquatic rescue operations involving complex environments, difficult victims, multiple casualties, and elevated operational risk.

- All Level 1–3 Competencies
- Advanced Aquatic Rescue
- Technical Rescue Principles
- Advanced Water Entry Techniques
- Advanced Victim Approach
- Difficult Victim Extraction
- Multiple-Victim Rescue Management
- Rescue Equipment Selection & Deployment
- Rescue Craft Awareness & Operations
- Advanced Rescue Tube Operations
- Rope & Line Rescue Principles
- Water-Based Search Techniques
- Missing Person Search Procedures

- Night/Emergency Low-Visibility Response
- Surf & Current Rescue Operations
- Complex Incident Management
- Rescue Team Coordination
- Rescue Scene Command Support
- Advanced CPR/AED Response
- Oxygen Administration
- Advanced First Aid
- Trauma Recognition
- Spinal Injury Management Principles
- Patient Packaging & Movement Principles
- Emergency Evacuation Coordination
- Hazardous Environment Awareness
- Rescue Risk Assessment
- Incident Command Principles
- Post-Incident Debriefing
- Technical Rescue Documentation

Level 4 Competency Outcome

The Guardian Rescue Technician can perform advanced rescue operations, manage complex aquatic incidents, support rescue leadership, coordinate rescue teams, and operate safely in elevated-risk environments.

LEVEL 5 — ASSISTANT GUARDIAN INSTRUCTOR

150 Hours

Core Competencies

An Assistant Guardian Instructor is qualified to support approved Guardian Instructors in the delivery, evaluation, and administration of Guardian training programs.

- All Level 1–4 Competencies
- Adult Learning Principles
- Instructional Methodology
- Lesson Planning
- Training Session Preparation
- Demonstration Techniques
- Practical Skills Instruction
- Classroom Facilitation
- Aquatic Skills Coaching
- CPR/AED Skills Instruction
- First Aid Skills Instruction
- Oxygen Administration Skills Instruction
- Rescue Skills Instruction
- Scenario-Based Training
- Candidate Coaching
- Candidate Observation
- Skills Evaluation Support
- Written Knowledge Assessment Support

- Performance Feedback
- Remediation Techniques
- Training Safety Management
- Equipment Preparation & Inspection
- Training Documentation
- Candidate Attendance & Records
- Certification Administration
- Instructor Communication
- Professional Conduct
- Quality Assurance Support
- Incident Management During Training

Level 5 Competency Outcome

The Assistant Guardian Instructor can assist an authorized Guardian Instructor in preparing, delivering, supervising, evaluating, and documenting Guardian training programs while maintaining training and safety standards.

LEVEL 6 — GUARDIAN INSTRUCTOR

210 Hours

Core Competencies

A Guardian Instructor is qualified to independently deliver approved Guardian training programs, evaluate candidates, conduct practical assessments, and recommend qualified candidates for certification.

- All Level 1–5 Competencies
- Advanced Adult Learning Principles
- Curriculum Interpretation
- Course Planning & Delivery
- Instructor-Led Classroom Training
- Practical Skills Training
- Demonstration & Coaching
- Scenario-Based Training Design
- Candidate Assessment
- Written Examination Administration
- Practical Skills Examination
- Competency-Based Evaluation
- Remediation & Corrective Training
- CPR/AED Instruction
- First Aid Instruction
- Oxygen Administration Instruction
- Pool Guardian Instruction
- Open Water Guardian Instruction
- Guardian Responder Instruction
- Rescue Technician Instruction
- Emergency Scenario Management
- Instructor Safety Management
- Training Risk Management

- Equipment & Training Facility Management
- Candidate Records Management
- Certification Documentation
- Certificate/License Administration
- Training Quality Assurance
- Instructor Ethics & Professional Standards
- Incident Investigation & Reporting
- Training Program Auditing
- Instructor Performance Evaluation
- Continuing Education Management

Level 6 Competency Outcome

The Guardian Instructor can independently conduct authorized Guardian courses, evaluate candidates against established competency standards, issue or recommend certification in accordance with OGI policy, maintain training records, and ensure consistent instructional quality.

LEVEL 7 — MASTER GUARDIAN INSTRUCTOR

260 Hours

Core Competencies

The Master Guardian Instructor represents the highest instructional competency level within the Guardian certification progression and is responsible for advanced instructor

development, quality assurance, curriculum implementation, and organizational training standards.

- All Level 1–6 Competencies
- Master-Level Instructional Leadership
- Instructor Development
- Instructor Mentoring
- Assistant Instructor Development
- Guardian Instructor Development
- Instructor Candidate Assessment
- Instructor Qualification Evaluation
- Instructor Performance Auditing
- Advanced Curriculum Development
- Curriculum Review & Standardization
- Training Program Design
- Advanced Scenario Development
- Competency Framework Development
- Assessment System Development
- Examination Development & Validation
- Quality Assurance Systems
- Training Center Quality Management
- Certification Program Administration
- Certification Registry Oversight
- Instructor Registry Oversight
- Continuing Education Program Development
- Remediation Program Development

- Advanced Risk Management
- Aquatic Training Risk Assessment
- Emergency Response Program Development
- Training Facility Auditing
- Instructor Standardization
- Certification Integrity & Control
- Documentation & Records Governance
- Advanced Incident Review
- Corrective Action Development
- Organizational Training Leadership
- Strategic Training Planning
- Instructor Ethics & Accountability
- OGI Training Standard Enforcement

Level 7 Competency Outcome

The Master Guardian Instructor can develop, mentor, evaluate, and oversee Guardian Instructors; standardize training delivery; support curriculum and assessment development; oversee instructional quality; and maintain the integrity of the OGI Guardian certification system.

PROGRESSION OF CORE COMPETENCY

Level 1 — Guardian Responder

RESPOND

Recognize emergencies, provide immediate assistance, and support emergency response.



Level 2 — Pool Guardian

PROTECT

Prevent incidents and manage aquatic safety within pool environments.



Level 3 — Open Water Guardian

RESCUE

Manage aquatic risks and conduct rescues in open-water environments.



Level 4 — Guardian Rescue Technician

SPECIALIZE

Perform advanced and complex aquatic rescue operations.



Level 5 — Assistant Guardian Instructor

ASSIST

Support qualified instructors in teaching and evaluating Guardian candidates.



Level 6 — Guardian Instructor

TEACH

Independently deliver, assess, and administer authorized Guardian programs.



Level 7 — Master Guardian Instructor

LEAD

Develop instructors, standardize training, oversee quality, and protect the integrity of the Guardian certification system.

MASTER COMPETENCY PRINCIPLE

Each level incorporates the competencies of the preceding level while adding new technical, operational, instructional, or leadership competencies.

Level 1: Respond

Level 2: Protect

Level 3: Rescue

Level 4: Specialize

Level 5: Assist

Level 6: Teach

Level 7: Lead

This creates a clear competency-based progression from Emergency Responder → Aquatic Guardian → Advanced Rescue Specialist → Instructor → Master Instructor.